

May

26

1940

Miracle of Dunkirk

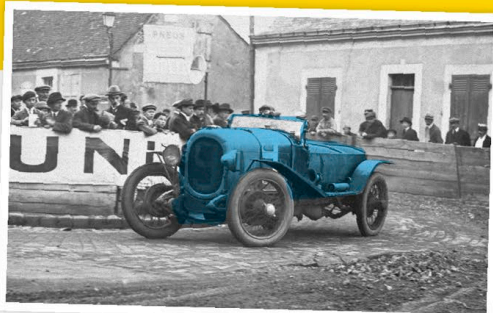
The evacuation of 338,226 Allied troops began on the beach of Dunkirk in France during World War II. More than 800 boats came to rescue the soldiers, who had become trapped between invading German forces and the North Sea.



1897

Gothic thriller

Dracula, a horror novel about the bloodsucking vampire Count Dracula by Bram Stoker, was published. London bookshops were the first to stock this terrifying Gothic classic, which was later translated into many languages and adapted for film and TV.



1923

Le Mans race

The first 24 Hours of Le Mans – one of the world's most famous car races – began near Le Mans, France. In this annual competition, drivers compete to cover the furthest distance in 24 hours.

Born this day

1966 Helena Bonham Carter, British actor. She is best known for playing quirky characters in period dramas and Bellatrix Lestrange in the *Harry Potter* series of films.

Also on this day

1954 A wooden funeral ship, built to take the soul of Egyptian pharaoh Khufu to heaven, was discovered buried next to the Great Pyramid at Giza, Egypt.

1998 Australia's first National Sorry Day was held. The annual event commemorates the mistreatment of First Australians by European settlers.

2019 Alan "Nasty" Nash won the World Toe Wrestling title for a record-breaking 16th time.